

Underclassmen Opportunities

Contributor Guide

How to add internships, programs, research opportunities,
and scholarships for freshmen & sophomores

github.com/Jose-Gael-Cruz-Lopez/underclassmen-opportunities

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1. What is This Repository?

The Underclassmen Opportunities repository is a community-driven, open-source list of internships, programs, research experiences, and scholarships specifically designed for freshmen and sophomores (Class of 2028 / Class of 2029) in tech and related fields.

Many companies offer programs specifically for first and second-year students that don't require prior experience. This repository makes those opportunities easy to find in one place.

Four Opportunity Categories

- Internships - Paid work experience (e.g., quantitative trading, SWE, automation)
- Programs - Fellowships, externships, summits, hackathons, bootcamps
- Research - REUs, SURF programs, lab experiences, conference presentations
- Scholarships - Financial awards for underclassmen in tech/STEM

IMPORTANT

This repository is **ONLY** for underclassmen-targeted opportunities. For general internships open to all class years, see: github.com/vanshb03/Summer2026-Internships

2. Who Can Contribute?

Anyone with a GitHub account can contribute! You don't need to know how to code. The entire process works through GitHub Issues - simple web forms that anyone can fill out.

What You Need

- A free GitHub account (sign up at github.com)
- A link to an underclassmen opportunity you want to share
- That's it! The automation handles the rest

TIP

You don't need to fork the repo, write code, or create pull requests. Just submit an issue using one of the templates and a maintainer will review it.

3. What Qualifies as an Opportunity?

Before submitting, make sure the opportunity meets these criteria:

Must Be:

- Specifically targeted at freshmen (1st year) and/or sophomores (2nd year)
- In tech, software engineering, data science, cybersecurity, or related STEM fields
- From a legitimate company, university, or organization
- Currently accepting applications (not expired)

Good Examples:

- Google STEP Internship (specifically for 1st/2nd year students)
- Salesforce Futureforce Launchpad (pre-internship for freshmen/sophomores)
- NSF REU programs that accept freshmen/sophomores
- Scholarships for underclassmen in STEM
- Early career immersion or discovery programs

Does NOT Qualify:

- General internships open to all class years (juniors, seniors, etc.)
- Full-time job postings for graduates
- Opportunities requiring 3+ years of experience
- Non-tech/non-STEM opportunities

TIP

Not sure if it qualifies? Submit it anyway! The maintainer will review it and let you know. It's better to share a potential opportunity than to miss one.

4. Three Ways to Add an Opportunity

The repository offers three submission methods, from simplest to most detailed. Choose whichever works best for you.

Method 1: Just Paste a Link (Recommended)

This is the easiest and fastest way. You just paste a URL and our AI system automatically extracts all the details (company name, role, location, category, etc.).

Step-by-Step:

- 1 Go to the repository: github.com/Jose-Gael-Cruz-Lopez/underclassmen-opportunities
- 2 Click the "Issues" tab at the top of the page
- 3 Click the green "New issue" button
- 4 Select "Add Opportunity (Just Paste Link)" template
- 5 Paste the URL of the opportunity into the link field
- 6 (Optional) Add any extra context in the notes field
- 7 Click "Submit new issue"
- 8 Wait for a maintainer to review and approve your submission

TIP

Use the direct application link whenever possible, not a LinkedIn post or news article about the opportunity. The AI works best with official application pages.

What the Link-Only Form Looks Like:

Add Opportunity (Just Paste Link)

Link to Opportunity *

+-----+

| <https://example.com/apply> |

+-----+

Additional Context (optional)

+-----+

| This is for freshmen only, deadline is May 15 |

+-----+

That's it! After you submit, the AI will visit the URL and extract all relevant details. A maintainer will review and approve it, and the opportunity will automatically appear in the README.

Method 2: Quick Add

Use this when the AI extraction doesn't work well (e.g., the opportunity is behind a login wall or on a non-standard page). You fill in just 4 required fields.

Step-by-Step:

- 1 Go to Issues > New issue
- 2 Select "Add Opportunity (Quick Add)" template
- 3 Fill in the 4 required fields (see below)
- 4 Click "Submit new issue"

Required Fields:

Field	Description	Example
Link	Direct URL to the application	https://jobs.google.com/...
Company	Company or organization name	Google
Role/Program	Title of the role or program	STEP Internship 2026
Category	Internship, Program, or Research	Internship

Optional Fields:

- Location - Defaults to 'Multiple Locations' if not provided
- Research Field - Only needed for Research category

Method 3: Full Details Form

This gives you complete control over every field. Use this when you want to make sure all details are exactly right.

Step-by-Step:

- 1 Go to Issues > New issue
- 2 Select "New Opportunity" template
- 3 Fill in all the required fields (see below)
- 4 Click "Submit new issue"

All Available Fields:

Field	Description	Required?
URL	Direct link to the application page	Yes
Company/Organization	Name of the company or school	Yes
Program/Role Title	Title of the opportunity	Yes
Category	Internship, Program, or Research	Yes
Type	Internship, Fellowship, Externship, etc.	Yes
Target Year	Freshman, Sophomore, Both, Any	Yes
Location	City, State (separate multiple with ;)	Yes
Season	Summer, Fall, Winter, Spring, Multiple	Yes
Sponsorship	Visa/citizenship requirements	Yes
Active	Is it currently accepting applications?	Yes
Field/Area	For research programs only	No
Email	Your email for attribution	No
Additional Notes	Any extra context	No

IMPORTANT

For locations, separate multiple locations with semicolons (;)

Example: New York, NY; San Francisco, CA; Remote

5. How to Close an Expired Opportunity

If you notice an opportunity that has expired, the application link is broken, or the program has been cancelled, you can request it be closed.

Step-by-Step:

- 1 Go to Issues > New issue
- 2 Select "Close Opportunity" template
- 3 Enter the Company/Organization name exactly as it appears in the README
- 4 Enter the Program/Role title exactly as it appears
- 5 (Optional) Paste the job URL to help identify the exact listing
- 6 Select a reason: deadline passed, position filled, posting removed, etc.
- 7 Click "Submit new issue"

Once approved, the opportunity will be marked with a lock icon in the README and moved to the bottom of its section. The application link will be removed.

TIP

Closing expired opportunities is just as valuable as adding new ones! It keeps the list accurate and saves other students time.

6. What Happens After You Submit?

Here's the complete workflow after you submit an issue:

- 1 You submit an issue using one of the templates
- 2 A maintainer reviews your submission for accuracy
- 3 The maintainer adds the "approved" label to your issue
- 4 GitHub Actions automation kicks in:
 - For link-only: AI visits the URL and extracts all details
 - For manual: The system parses the fields you filled in
 - Duplicate detection checks if it already exists
 - The opportunity is added to listings.json (the data store)
 - The README tables are automatically regenerated
- 5 Your issue is automatically closed with a success message

6 The opportunity now appears on the main README for everyone to see!

The entire process is usually completed within minutes of approval. You'll receive a GitHub notification when your issue is closed.

7. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How long does it take for my submission to appear?

A: Once a maintainer approves it, the automation runs in about 1-2 minutes. Maintainer review time varies, but is usually within 24 hours.

Q: My submission was marked as a duplicate. What happened?

A: The system detected that the same opportunity already exists in the list (matched by URL or by company + title). Check the existing entries first!

Q: The AI extraction got something wrong. What do I do?

A: Submit a new issue using the 'Close Opportunity' template to remove the incorrect entry, then re-submit using 'Quick Add' or 'New Opportunity' with the correct details.

Q: Can I edit an existing opportunity?

A: Direct editing is not supported. Close the old listing and add a new one with updated information.

Q: I found a great opportunity but I'm not sure if it's for underclassmen.

A: Submit it! Include a note about your uncertainty. The maintainer will verify if it qualifies. If not, they'll let you know.

Q: Do I need to know Git or coding to contribute?

A: No! The entire process works through GitHub's web interface. Just fill out a form and click submit.

Q: Can I submit scholarships?

A: Yes! Scholarships for underclassmen in tech/STEM are welcome. Use the 'New Opportunity' template and select the appropriate category.

8. Tips for Finding Opportunities

Here are some great places to find underclassmen-specific opportunities:

Where to Look:

- LinkedIn - Search for 'freshman internship', 'sophomore program', 'early career'
- Handshake - Filter by class year in your school's portal
- Company career pages - Look for 'early talent', 'discovery', 'exploratory' programs
- ColorStack, NSBE, SHPE, SWE, oSTEM - Community Slack channels
- GitHub repos - Summer2026-Internships, PittCSC, SimplifyJobs
- University career centers - Often have exclusive underclassmen programs
- Twitter/X - Follow recruiters who post early career opportunities

Keywords That Signal Underclassmen Programs:

- "First-year" or "Freshman" or "Sophomore"
- "Early career" or "Early talent" or "Early engagement"
- "Discovery program" or "Exploratory program"
- "Pre-internship" or "Launchpad" or "Immersion"
- "Class of 2028" or "Class of 2029"
- "No experience required" + internship

Before You Submit, Double-Check:

- The application is still open (not expired)
- The opportunity specifically mentions freshmen/sophomores
- You're using the direct application link (not a social media post)
- It hasn't already been added (search the README first)

Thank you for contributing!

Every opportunity you share helps a fellow underclassman
take the next step in their tech career.

Questions? Open an issue using the 'Other' template or reach out to Jose Cruz-Lopez

github.com/Jose-Gael-Cruz-Lopez/underclassmen-opportunities